

ZUBA

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Zuba, The Official App of the Botswana Premier League



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1. Executive Summary

1.1 Overview of the Proposal

This proposal outlines a comprehensive digital transformation initiative for the Botswana Premier League (BPL) through the development of an integrated **Mobile Ticketing & Media Ecosystem**. The proposed system aims to solve the current challenges facing BPL's paper-based ticketing process, which has proven to be inefficient, costly, and vulnerable to revenue loss.

At the heart of this solution is a **BPL Mobile Application** that combines smart ticketing with real-time media engagement, giving fans a seamless, secure, and personalized experience. Accompanying the app is a **Steward Scanning App** to manage ticket validation at venues and a powerful **Customer Relationship Management (CRM) Platform** for administrators to manage all system interactions—from tickets and content to user and steward analytics.

Together, these three components create a sustainable, scalable, and data-driven ecosystem designed to recover lost revenue, enhance fan engagement, and future-proof the Botswana Premier League's digital presence.

1.2 Vision for the Botswana Premier League (BPL)

To position the Botswana Premier League as a **digitally advanced, commercially viable, and globally admired football league** by:

- Creating direct, personalized connections with fans through mobile technology
- Enabling secure and transparent digital ticketing that reduces leakage
- Enhancing visibility for clubs, players, and sponsors through engaging media
- Using data to make smarter business and sporting decisions across the league

The vision is not just about ticketing; it's about **redefining how fans interact with football in Botswana**—making every touchpoint meaningful, measurable, and monetizable.

1.3 Strategic Objectives

The proposal is built on the following strategic goals:

- **Revenue Recovery & Growth:** Eliminate ticketing inefficiencies and maximize income by digitizing the purchase, validation, and transfer of tickets.

- **Fan Engagement:** Deliver a tailored fan experience through team personalization, news feeds, and push notifications.
- **Operational Efficiency:** Streamline venue access via steward scanning and provide real-time attendance monitoring.
- **Data-Driven Decision Making:** Leverage a 360° CRM dashboard to gain insights into user behavior, ticketing trends, and content engagement.
- **Brand Strengthening:** Position BPL as a leader in African sports innovation through a modern, professional, and scalable digital platform.
- **Scalability & Sustainability:** Build a foundation that supports future integrations such as e-commerce, loyalty programs, or fantasy leagues.

2. Problem Statement

2.1 Current Ticketing Workflow

The Botswana Premier League (BPL) currently relies on a **manual ticketing system** where physical tickets are printed in bulk and distributed to retail outlets across the country. Fans are required to visit these outlets in person to purchase matchday tickets. At the stadium, stewards check the printed tickets manually, often without any form of digital validation.

This outdated system introduces inefficiencies at nearly every stage—from production and distribution to validation and reconciliation—leaving room for human error, fraud, and financial leakage.

2.2 Identified Challenges

a. Revenue Leakage

- A significant portion of ticket revenue never reaches the BPL due to manual handling and untraceable cash transactions.
- Unsold or lost tickets result in sunk printing costs, while overprinting inflates operational expenses.

b. Distribution Inefficiencies

- Physical distribution is time-consuming and limited by geography.
- Fans outside urban centers face difficulties accessing tickets, often leading to reduced attendance.

c. Ticket Fraud and Misuse

- Lack of centralized tracking allows for counterfeit tickets and reselling without oversight.
- Manual validation at entry points makes fraud detection nearly impossible in real time.

d. Limited Accessibility and Engagement

- No mechanism exists for fans to buy tickets online or receive instant updates.
- The current model fails to build long-term engagement or collect user insights to drive loyalty or marketing campaigns.

e. Lack of Data and Insights

- With no digital trail, the league is unable to gather meaningful statistics on fan behavior, attendance patterns, or transaction history—data that is crucial for sponsors, clubs, and management decisions.

2.3 Need for Digital Transformation

To remain competitive and financially sustainable, the BPL must embrace a digital-first approach. A **centralized mobile ticketing and media platform** will not only solve existing logistical and financial inefficiencies but will also create new revenue streams and engagement opportunities.

Digital transformation will:

- Offer **convenient ticket purchasing** for fans anytime, anywhere
- Ensure **secure, traceable transactions** and eliminate ticket fraud
- Allow **real-time updates and fan communication** via notifications
- Provide BPL with **data-driven insights** to inform marketing, operations, and partnerships
- Lay the groundwork for a **sustainable digital ecosystem** that can grow with the league

3. Proposed Solution Overview

3.1 Introduction to the BPL Mobile App Ecosystem

To address the operational, financial, and fan engagement challenges currently facing the Botswana Premier League (BPL), we propose the creation of a **smart, mobile-first ecosystem** that redefines how football fans interact with the league.

At its core, the solution is a **multi-platform system** centered around a mobile application tailored for BPL supporters. This mobile app enables secure digital ticketing, fan personalization, team-centered content delivery, and interactive engagement. Supporting this core platform are two essential components:

- A **Steward Scanning App** for real-time ticket validation and event access control.
- A **Central CRM Platform** for league administrators to manage tickets, media content, users, and performance dashboards.

This ecosystem creates a unified and modern infrastructure that connects fans, clubs, stewards, and administrators in one seamless digital experience—while unlocking revenue, data, and engagement opportunities previously out of reach.

3.2 Benefits of a Digitized Ticketing and Media System

Area	Benefit
Revenue	Increased income through direct-to-fan sales, reduced leakage, and in-app advertising.
Operations	Streamlined ticket distribution, reduced printing and logistics costs.
Security	Real-time ticket validation eliminates fraud and ensures safe access control.
Fan Engagement	Personalized homepages, targeted content, and notifications based on fan preferences.
Accessibility	Easy, on-demand ticket purchases for users anywhere in Botswana.
Analytics	Actionable insights on fan behavior, sales trends, and event performance.
Brand Value	Elevated image of the BPL as a modern, innovative, and tech-savvy organization.

This transition is not just functional—it is transformational. It positions BPL as a **data-driven, fan-first league** ready to scale with global standards.

3.3 System Components at a Glance

1. BPL Mobile App (For Fans)

- a. OTP login via WhatsApp
- b. Personalized team selection and content
- c. Match ticket purchases (single, seasonal, or cross-team)
- d. Ticket downloads and peer-to-peer transfers
- e. Access to news articles, promotional content, and team updates
- f. Real-time push notifications (offers, news, changes)

2. Steward App (For Venue Staff)

- a. Scan QR/barcode tickets for real-time validation
- b. Log attendance and match entry
- c. Offline functionality with later syncing
- d. Steward activity tracking

3. CRM & Admin Dashboard (For BPL Management)

- a. Central management of tickets, articles, and app content
- b. User activity analytics and behavioral segmentation
- c. Steward monitoring and performance metrics
- d. Notification management and campaign tools
- e. Custom dashboards for strategic reporting and insights

This ecosystem provides an **end-to-end solution** for the Botswana Premier League—designed to solve today’s problems and power tomorrow’s opportunities.

4. BPL Mobile App Features

The BPL Mobile App is designed as a **fan-first digital hub** that combines seamless ticketing with personalized media experiences. It is not just a utility—it’s a gateway to the league’s culture, content, and community.

4.1 User Registration & Login (WhatsApp OTP Integration)

Fans can register and log in using a simple **WhatsApp-based One-Time Password (OTP)** system. This approach eliminates friction by using a platform most fans already trust and use daily.

Benefits:

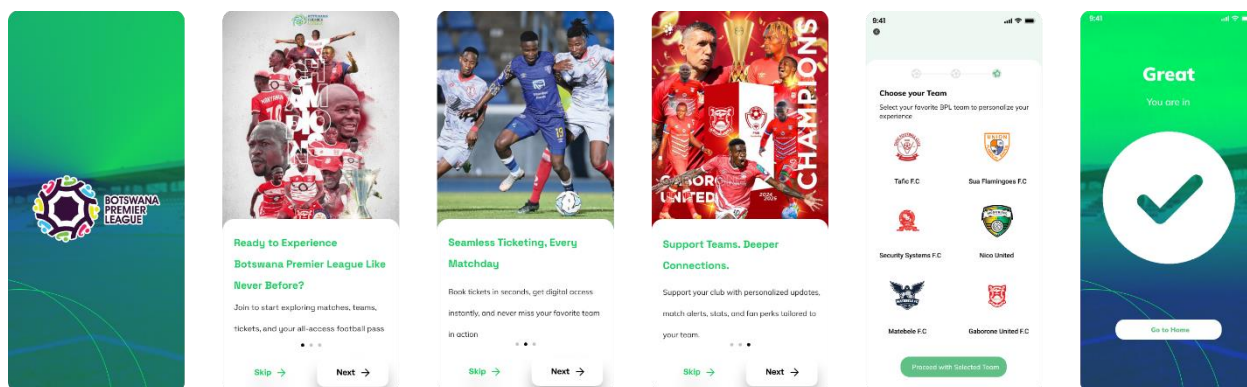
- No passwords required
- High adoption rates due to WhatsApp familiarity
- Fast and secure authentication

4.2 Team Personalization & Preferences

During onboarding, users select their **preferred BPL team**. This choice drives personalized experiences throughout the app—content, ticket promotions, and notifications are tailored to their loyalty.

Benefits:

- Improved fan engagement
- Increased relevance of news and offers
- Opportunity for team-specific marketing campaigns

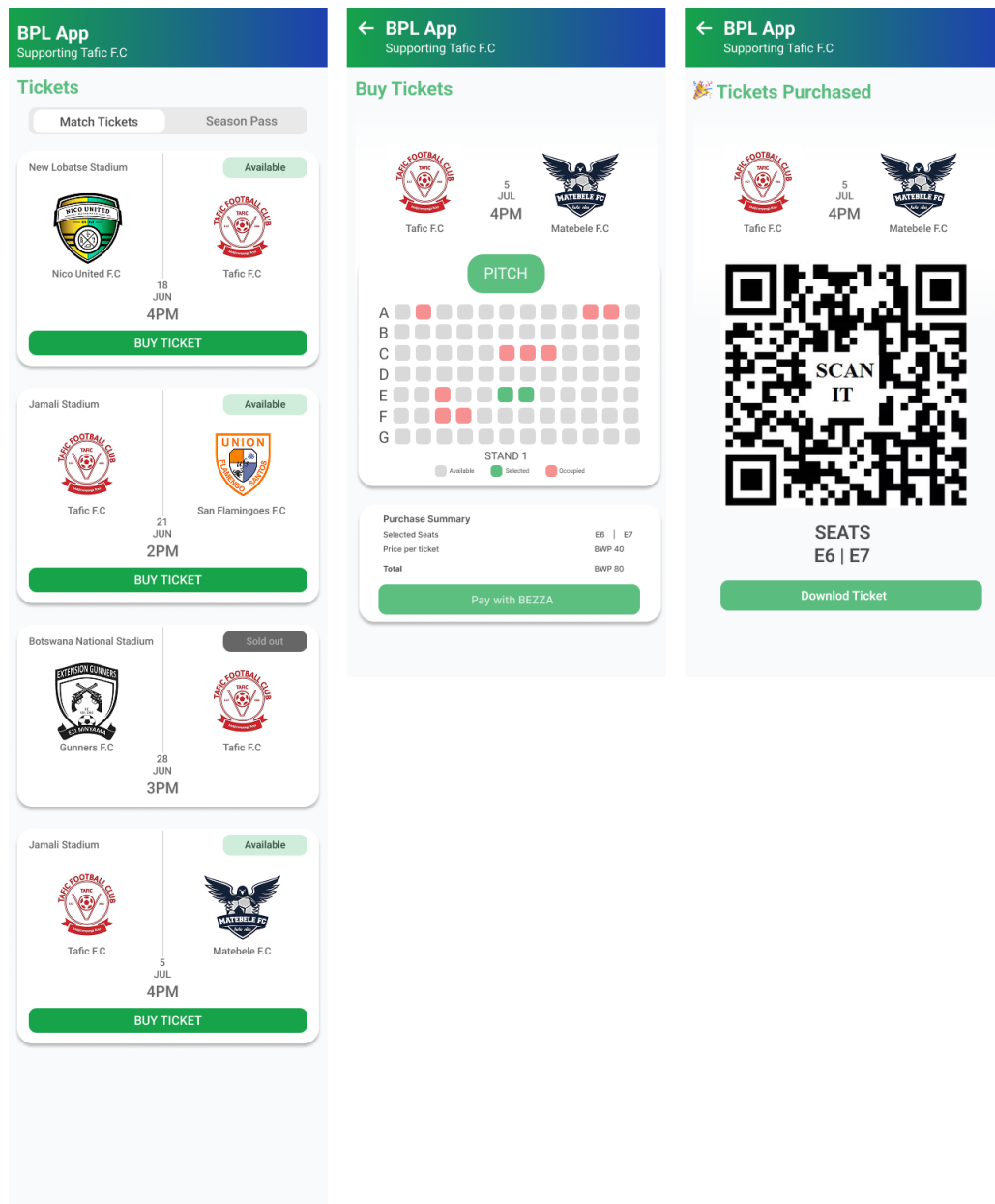


4.3 Match Ticket Purchase (Single/Other Teams)

Users can browse upcoming matches and purchase tickets directly in the app. While the experience is centered around their favorite team, users are free to purchase tickets for any fixture in the league.

Features:

- Mobile wallet(BEZZA) or card payments
- Seat selection (if applicable)
- Match details and kickoff reminders

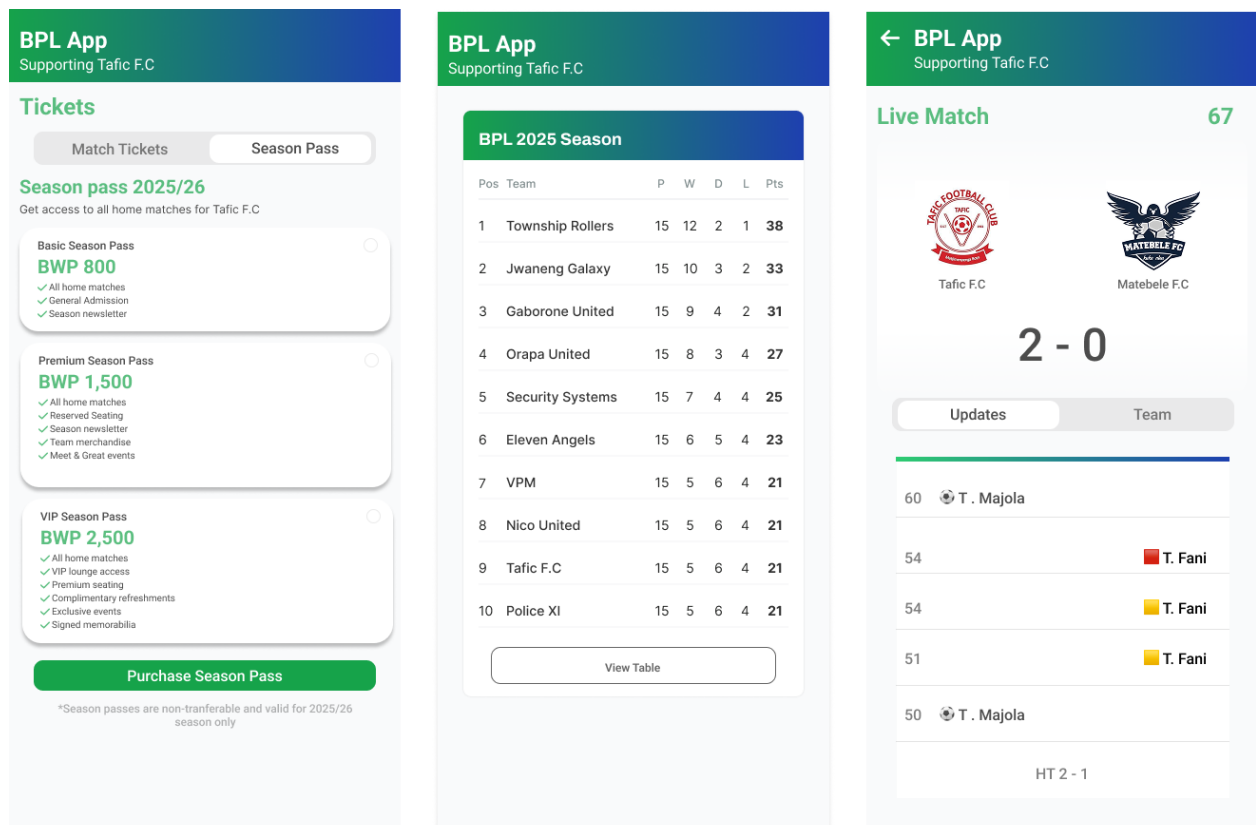


4.4 Seasonal Pass Purchase

The app allows fans to buy **season tickets** that give them access to all home matches for their chosen team or the entire league.

Benefits:

- Discounted pricing to encourage early commitment
- QR-based digital pass for easy scanning
- In-app renewal and management of the pass



4.5 Ticket Download, Sharing & Transfer

Each purchased ticket is automatically added to the user's **ticket vault** within the app. Fans can:

- Download tickets for offline access
- Receive tickets on WhatsApp and Email
- **Transfer tickets** to friends or family (who also use the app)
- View ticket history and upcoming events

Benefits:

- Convenient and traceable peer-to-peer transfers
- Eliminates need for printed tickets entirely
- Reduces fraud risk through secure QR generation

4.6 Article & Newsfeed Integration

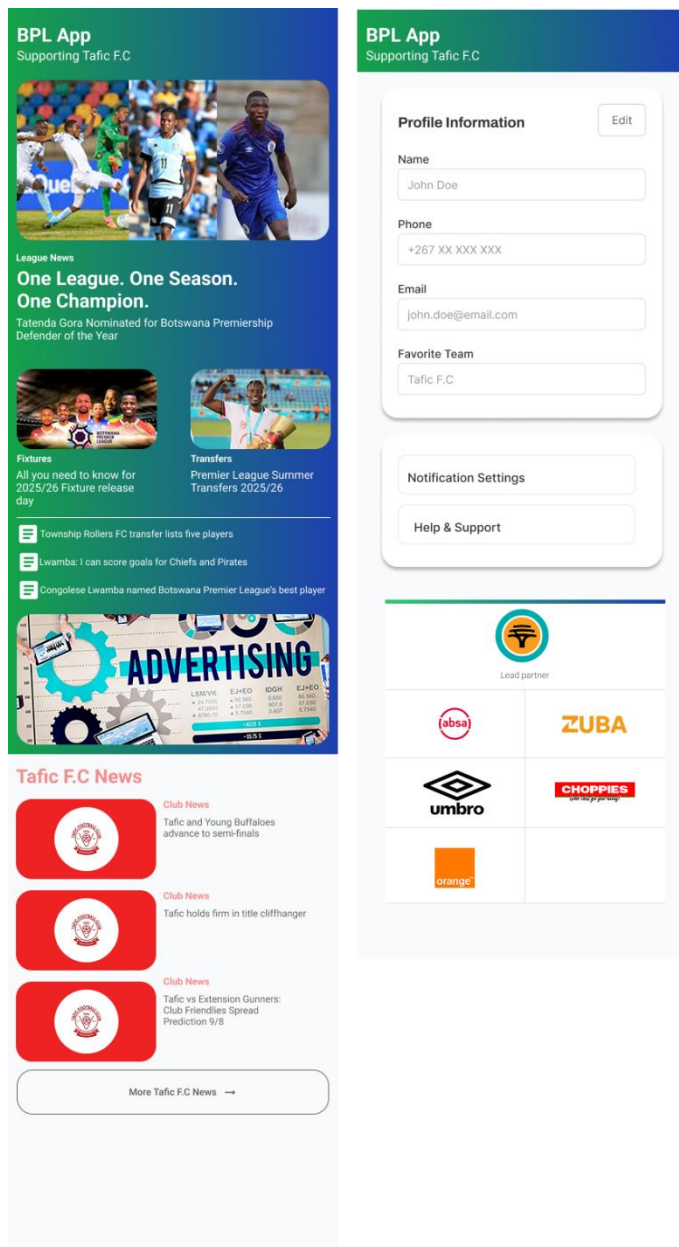
The app's homepage becomes a **content-rich newsfeed**, tailored to the user's team and interests.

Features:

- Latest articles, interviews, and game previews
- Post-match analysis and team announcements
- Stories prioritized by team and fan behavior

Benefits:

- Keeps fans returning to the app regularly
- Opens new advertising and sponsorship inventory
- Drives emotional connection with the league



4.7 In-App Advertising (Team & User-Centric)

Monetization is enhanced through **smart ad placements** within the app that align with the fan's preferences and behaviors.

Examples:

- Club-branded merchandise promos for selected teams
- Geo-targeted ads for local sponsors
- Full-screen offers tied to ticket purchases

Benefits:

- Non-intrusive ad model integrated with user interest
- Revenue opportunity for BPL and clubs
- Partner appeal through high-precision targeting

4.8 Real-Time Push Notifications (News, Offers, Alerts)

Fans receive relevant updates as they happen. Notifications are intelligently segmented based on team preference, app activity, and user behavior.

Types of Notifications:

- Matchday reminders and kickoff alerts
- Breaking news or injury updates
- Ticket sale announcements and exclusive offers
- Transfer deadline alerts or live match score updates

Benefits:

- Boosts user engagement and app usage
- Drives timely action (e.g., ticket purchases)
- Reinforces brand presence with fans

The BPL Mobile App is more than a ticketing tool—**it is a digital companion for every fan**. Built with scalability and personalization at its core, it sets a new standard for sports engagement in Botswana.

5. Steward App Module

The **Steward App** is a lightweight, purpose-built mobile application designed for use by stadium personnel and venue gatekeepers. Its primary function is to facilitate **real-time ticket validation**, enhance crowd control, and provide accurate attendance data—all while ensuring ease of use in both online and offline environments.

This module ensures **secure access control** and provides BPL with complete visibility into matchday operations and steward accountability.

5.1 Ticket Scanning Functionality

Stewards use the app to **scan QR codes** or barcodes on digital tickets at stadium entry points. Each scan checks the validity of the ticket in real-time and prevents reuse or duplication.

Features:

- Quick camera-based scanning
- Real-time validation with backend sync
- Immediate feedback on ticket status (valid, expired, already used)

Benefits:

- Fast and secure gate processing
- Reduces fraud and counterfeit ticket usage
- Improves matchday logistics and entry flow

5.2 Offline Scanning & Syncing

Recognizing that some stadiums may face intermittent connectivity, the Steward App supports **offline scanning**. Scanned data is cached locally and automatically synced to the server once internet access is restored.

Benefits:

- Uninterrupted operation in low-connectivity environments
- Ensures data integrity and continuity
- Prevents crowding or delays due to network issues

5.3 Attendance Monitoring

Every scanned ticket contributes to a **live attendance counter** that feeds directly into the CRM dashboard. This allows BPL and club administrators to track turnout in real time and analyze attendance patterns over time.

Features:

- Real-time attendance stats per gate or steward
- Aggregated match attendance data
- Comparison across games and teams

Benefits:

- Enables better security, seating, and resource planning
- Supports accurate financial reconciliation
- Empowers clubs with valuable fan behavior data

5.4 Steward Activity Logs

The app logs steward actions to maintain **accountability and transparency**. Each scan is associated with a steward ID, time-stamp, and location (if GPS-enabled).

Features:

- Steward login and access control
- Log history per steward (scans per match, time active)
- Reporting of unusual patterns (e.g., repeated scans, skipped validations)

Benefits:

- Enables auditing and performance reviews
- Ensures fair steward rotation and efficiency
- Reduces human error and malpractice

The Steward App is a **critical enabler of operational excellence**—bridging the gap between digital ticketing and real-world execution. By providing real-time visibility and secure access management, it ensures a seamless fan experience while reinforcing the integrity of the ticketing system.



BPL Steward
Ticket Validation System

Steward ID

PIN

Login

Authorized Personnel Only
Contact supervisor for access issues

Select Match
Choose the match you're stewarding

Township Rollers vs Gaborone United
National Stadium
Dec 20, 2024 15:00
Gate A
Start Scanning

Jwaneng Galaxy vs Orapa United
Jwaneng Stadium
Dec 22, 2024 17:30
Gate B
Start Scanning

Township Rollers vs Gaborone United
Gate A - National Stadium

Camera Ready
Tap to scan QR code

Scan Ticket

Recent Scans
No scans yet

Session Stats

0 Valid Scans	0 Invalid Scans
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6. Central Admin CRM Management System

The **Central CRM Management System** is the backbone of the entire BPL digital ecosystem. Designed for league administrators and club officials, this web-based platform provides a **360° view** of all system operations—ticketing, content, users, stewards, and analytics—in a single, intuitive interface.

This admin portal empowers BPL to make real-time decisions, monitor performance, manage digital assets, and run targeted engagement campaigns—all through a secure, role-based system.

6.1 Ticket Sales Management

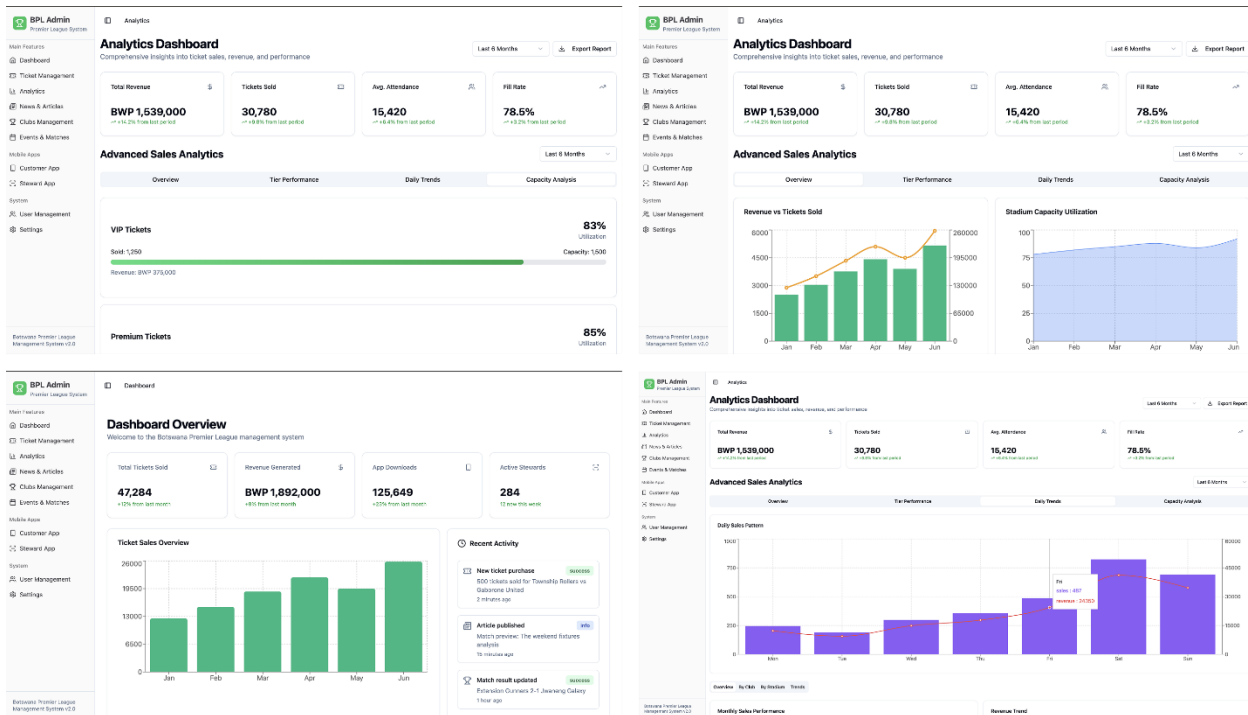
The CRM provides full oversight of ticketing operations, including match-by-match performance, seasonal passes, and transfer activity.

Capabilities:

- Create and manage fixtures and ticket types
- Track ticket sales in real time across matches and teams
- Monitor ticket transfer history and usage
- View refunds, cancellations, and invalid scans

Benefits:

- Full transparency in ticket revenue
- Eliminates manual reconciliation
- Supports informed pricing and promotional strategies



6.2 Content Management (Articles, Media, Ads)

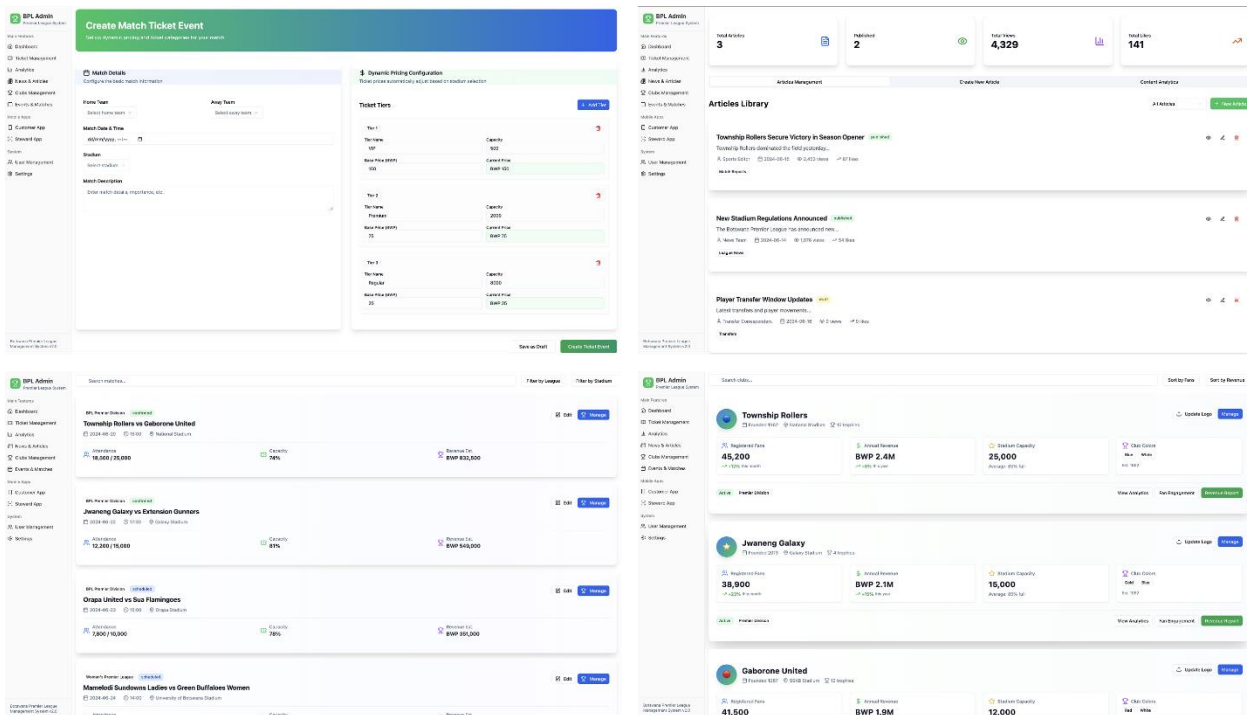
The platform includes a **Content Management System (CMS)** for managing all fan-facing content across the mobile app.

Capabilities:

- Create, schedule, and publish articles, interviews, and match previews
- Upload multimedia (images, videos, banners)
- Assign content to specific teams or user segments
- Manage in-app ads and promotional slots

Benefits:

- Keeps the app fresh and relevant
- Enables monetization through partner and sponsor placements
- Empowers clubs to communicate directly with fans



6.3 User Engagement & Activity Analytics

BPL can gain deep insights into how fans interact with the app—from ticket purchases to article views.

Metrics Tracked:

- Active users and engagement time
- Ticket purchase trends (by team, match, or time period)
- Article views, shares, and reading completion
- User retention, churn, and app version adoption

Benefits:

- Drives data-informed decision making
- Helps tailor content and offers to maximize impact
- Supports sponsor reporting and value demonstration

6.4 Steward Oversight and Audit Trails

The CRM offers detailed logs of all steward activities for each event.

Capabilities:

- Track number of tickets scanned per steward
- Analyze scan accuracy and timing
- Identify stewards with unusual patterns or discrepancies
- Export logs for auditing and review

Benefits:

- Enhances accountability at match venues
- Supports performance evaluation and rotation planning
- Prevents fraud or misuse at the entry level

6.5 Custom Dashboards & Reporting

Dynamic dashboards provide stakeholders with the data they need—at a glance.

Features:

- Customizable widgets for key metrics (e.g., ticket sales, attendance, content views)
- Exportable reports (PDF, Excel) for board meetings and strategic sessions
- Role-based dashboards for different user levels (league, club, sponsor)

Benefits:

- Empowers executive leadership with real-time insights
- Reduces manual report generation
- Enhances transparency and stakeholder confidence

6.6 Notification & Campaign Management

The CRM enables BPL to communicate with users directly via the app using a **targeted notification engine**.

Features:

- Schedule and push notifications by user segment (e.g., team, activity level, location)
- Create marketing campaigns for matchdays, merchandise, or events
- A/B test messages for optimal impact
- Track open rates and click-throughs

Benefits:

- Drives timely fan engagement
- Promotes match attendance and app re-use
- Opens new revenue channels through event promotion and digital campaigns

The **Central CRM System** turns the BPL digital platform into a **smart, adaptive, and monetizable engine**—giving administrators and clubs the tools they need to elevate the league’s professionalism, profitability, and fan experience.

7. System Architecture & Technology Stack

The BPL digital ecosystem is designed using a **modular, cloud-native architecture** that ensures high performance, security, scalability, and easy maintainability. This architecture underpins all three major system components—**Mobile App**, **Steward App**, and the **CRM Admin Console**—allowing seamless communication and centralized control via secure APIs.

7.1 Mobile App Architecture

The BPL Mobile App (for fans) and the Steward App (for venue staff) are both built on a **hybrid mobile framework** (Flutter), ensuring rapid development and cross-platform support for Android and iOS.

Key Components:

- **Frontend:** Flutter (Dart)
- **Authentication:** WhatsApp OTP
- **Storage:** Secure local cache for offline access (tickets, articles)
- **Notifications:** Firebase Cloud Messaging (FCM) for real-time updates
- **Analytics:** App usage and behavioral tracking via Firebase or Segment

Advantages:

- Cross-platform development for faster rollout
- Smooth user experience even in low-bandwidth areas
- Modular update delivery (e.g., content refresh without app store re-submission)

7.2 Backend & API Design

The backend acts as the **central brain** of the system—managing data, processing transactions, serving content, and enforcing business logic.

Core Technologies:

- **Backend Framework:** Node.js (Express)
- **Database:** Redis (caching), Firebase Realtime DB (optional for live events)
- **Authentication:** OAuth2 with JWT tokens, WhatsApp OTP provider integration
- **API Layer:** RESTful APIs with GraphQL support for CRM dashboards
- **Cloud Infrastructure:** Google Cloud Platform

Core Responsibilities:

- Ticket generation, validation, and transfer logic
- Secure user and steward management
- Article, media, and ad serving
- Role-based API access and logging

7.3 CRM & Admin Console

The CRM system is a **web-based admin interface** built using modern frontend frameworks like React or Angular, with dashboards powered by analytics and BI integrations.

Key Technologies:

- **Frontend:** React.js
- **Data Visualization:** Chart.js, D3.js, or integrated BI tools (e.g., Metabase, Power BI)
- **CMS Framework:** Strapi, Directus, or custom CMS
- **Authentication:** Admin roles and permissions with audit logs
- **Hosting:** Cloud-hosted with CDN acceleration (Firebase Hosting)

Features:

- Ticket configuration & sales monitoring
- User and steward activity logs
- Article and ad management with media uploads
- Customizable dashboards and reports

7.4 Security & Compliance

Security is a core pillar of the BPL digital platform, ensuring protection for users, stewards, and sensitive league data.

Security Features:

- End-to-end encryption of ticket data and QR codes
- OTP-based secure login with expiring sessions
- Role-based access control (RBAC) across all systems
- API rate limiting, IP whitelisting, and token-based authorization
- Regular vulnerability scans and patching
- GDPR-aligned data practices for privacy and consent

Compliance Goals:

- Data protection aligned with Botswana and international standards

- Secure hosting on SOC 2 / ISO 27001 certified cloud providers
- Payment gateway PCI-DSS compliance for all transactions

7.5 Scalability and Maintenance

The architecture is built for **horizontal scalability**, allowing the system to grow effortlessly as more users, clubs, and stewards join.

Scalability Features:

- Auto-scaling backend via Kubernetes or serverless (e.g., AWS Lambda, Cloud Functions)
- Load balancing across services and database sharding for large datasets
- Modular services allow feature-based scaling (e.g., ticketing independent from content)

Maintenance & Monitoring:

- CI/CD pipeline for zero-downtime deployments
- Real-time monitoring via tools like Datadog, Sentry, or Prometheus
- Regular backups and rollback mechanisms
- Scheduled performance and security audits

This **robust and future-proof architecture** ensures that the BPL digital ecosystem is reliable, secure, and ready to grow with the league's evolving needs—providing fans with a seamless experience and the organization with deep operational control.

8. Implementation Roadmap

The implementation of the BPL Digital Ticketing & Media System is structured into clearly defined phases to ensure smooth execution, early feedback, and on-time delivery ahead of the 2025/26 season kickoff.

The roadmap emphasizes **agile delivery**, **stakeholder alignment**, and **risk-managed rollout** with a pilot-first strategy.

8.1 Project Phases & Milestones

1. **Requirements Gathering & Planning**
Kickoff meetings, stakeholder input, technical scoping.
2. **Design (UI/UX, System Architecture)**
Wireframes, brand alignment, architecture diagrams.
3. **Development Phase 1: Core App & Ticketing**
Build ticketing engine, login, team personalization.
4. **Development Phase 2: Media & Notifications**
Articles, ads, push notifications, in-app content delivery.
5. **Development Phase 3: Steward App & CRM**
Develop steward scanning module and central CRM platform.
6. **Integration & Testing**
System QA, performance testing, security audit.
7. **Pilot Rollout & Feedback**
Limited launch in select venues or matches.
8. **Final Launch Preparation**
Polishing, marketing content setup, App Store prep.
9. **Official Go-Live**
Nationwide launch with operational support.

8.2 Estimated Timelines

- **Start Date:** June 23, 2025
- **Pilot Rollout:** July 29, 2025
- **Go-Live:** August 8, 2025

8.3 Pilot Rollout Strategy

- Deploy to select stadiums in late July for 1–2 pre-season matches.
- Train stewards and venue operators.

- Collect user and steward feedback via the CRM.
- Finalize based on real match-day observations.

9. Financial Overview & Cost Breakdown

This financial model enables BPL to adopt a modern digital ticketing and media platform without any upfront investment. The entire system will be fully financed and developed by Zuba, a technology and media company owned by Reon Capital.

BPL will repay Zuba over a 24-month period after launch, including a 20% premium on the initial build cost. This spreads financial commitment and ensures the league can modernize without financial strain.

9.1 One-Time Development Costs

Item	Description	Estimated Cost (BWP)
Mobile App Development	Fan-facing ticketing & media app (iOS/Android)	625,000
Steward App Development	Lightweight scanning and logging app	100,000
CRM & Admin Console	Web platform with dashboards, CMS, and analytics	1,150,000
UI/UX Design	Custom branding, wireframes, and user journeys	75,000
Backend Infrastructure & API Development	Ticket engine, media delivery, notification manager	500,000
Testing & QA	Functional, performance, and security testing	50,000
Project Management & Documentation	End-to-end delivery management and user documentation	50,000

Total: BWP 2,550,000 (Covered entirely by Zuba)

9.2 Repayment Model (BPL to Zuba)

- **Repayment Period:** 24 months
- **Premium (20%):** BWP 425,000 (Included in module pricing)
- **Total Repayment to Zuba: BWP 2,550,000**

- **Monthly Installment (24 months): BWP 106, 250 + 20% BPL Ticket Revenue**

This structure provides **BPL full access to the platform immediately**, with repayments starting post-launch and structured for affordability.

9.2 Operational & Hosting Costs (Annual)

Item	Description	Estimated Annual Cost (BWP)
Cloud Hosting	GCP Infrastructure	270,000
Database & Storage	Managed databases and file storage	140,000
SMS/WhatsApp OTP Integration	Based on estimated user base (volume-driven)	40,000
Push Notification Services	Firebase or 3rd-party notification gateway	10,000
Maintenance & Updates	Bug fixes, updates, minor enhancements	75,000
Support & Monitoring	Monitoring tools	30,000
Salaries & HR	Developers, designers, project manager, support staff	1,385,000

Total (Yearly): BWP 1,950,000 (Covered entirely by Zuba)

9.3 Add-Ons (Future Enhancements)

Item	Description	Estimated Cost (BWP)
Loyalty/Rewards System	Fan points, gamification, discounts	155,500
Video Highlights & Streaming Module	Embedding highlight clips, interviews	300,000
E-Commerce Marketplace	Team merchandise, digital collectibles	200,500

Total (As Needed): BWP 656,000 (Covered entirely by Zuba)

9.5 Strategic Financial Benefits to BPL

- **Zero upfront cost** thanks to Zuba's financing
- **Affordable monthly repayment** with a 2-year spread
- **End of revenue leakage** and fraud in ticket sales
- **Monetizable channels** like ads, premium passes, and merchandise
- **Predictable operating costs** for sustainability

Summary (in BWP)

Total Development Cost	BWP 2,550,000 (Funded by Zuba)
Total Repayment to Zuba	BWP 2,550,000 (incl. 20% premium)
Monthly Repayment	BWP 106,250 for 24 months + 20% BPL Ticket Revenue
Annual Operational Cost	BWP 1,950,000

This structure supports **BPL's vision of modernization without the burden of capital risk**—unlocking a future-ready league with digital ticketing, fan engagement, and revenue transparency.

10. Risk Management & Mitigation Plan

Deploying a new digital platform in a high-profile and operationally complex environment like the Botswana Premier League requires proactive identification and management of potential risks. This section outlines key technical, operational, and adoption-related risks, along with mitigation strategies to ensure project success.

10.1 Identified Risks

Risk Category	Description
Technical Risk	System bugs, infrastructure failures, or scalability issues under peak load.
Adoption Risk	Fans or stewards may be resistant or slow to adopt the new digital system.
Connectivity Issues	Venues in remote areas may have unreliable internet connections.
Data Privacy & Security	Breaches or unauthorized access to user data or CRM content.
Operational Risk	Errors during match day operations (e.g. scanning delays or CRM downtime).
Vendor or API Dependency	Dependency on third-party services (e.g. WhatsApp OTP, cloud hosting).
Cost Overruns	Unanticipated expenses in development or deployment phases.

10.2 Mitigation Strategies

Risk	Mitigation Plan
System Bugs or Failures	Perform end-to-end testing; implement CI/CD pipelines; stage deployment with sandbox testing.
Low User Adoption	Launch awareness campaigns with clubs; create in-app onboarding tutorials; partner with influencers.
Connectivity Challenges	Enable offline ticket scanning with periodic sync; use lightweight data formats for ticket data.
Security Breaches	Enforce JWT-based authentication; encrypt all sensitive data; conduct routine security audits.

CRM Downtime During Matches	Use load balancing and redundancy; conduct stress tests before go-live; enable offline fallback logs.
Third-party Service Failure	Have alternative OTP and hosting vendors as part of a redundancy plan.
Budget Deviations	Adopt agile delivery to control scope; allocate 10–15% buffer in the budget planning.

10.3 Contingency Planning

- **Steward SOP Playbook:** Provide stewards with printed fallback procedures and offline tools in case of app failure.
- **Hotline & Live Support:** Activate live technical support during all pilot and match day events.
- **Phased Rollout:** Begin with select matches to gather feedback and fix issues before full launch.
- **Stakeholder Involvement:** Engage clubs, sponsors, and key BPL leadership throughout development to ensure buy-in and alignment.

10.4 Continuous Risk Monitoring

- A dedicated **Project Management Office (PMO)** will be tasked with weekly check-ins and performance tracking.
- Real-time error monitoring (via tools like Sentry, LogRocket, or Firebase Crashlytics) will ensure fast response to emerging issues.
- CRM dashboards will include **risk indicators** tied to adoption rates, app usage patterns, and scanning error frequency.

By embedding resilience, redundancy, and proactive mitigation into the foundation of the system, this proposal ensures that BPL’s digital transformation is **not only innovative—but operationally reliable and future-proof.**

11. Conclusion & Strategic Recommendation

11.1 Closing Summary

The Botswana Premier League (BPL) stands at a pivotal moment in its evolution. As football becomes more than just a game—transforming into an experience that engages fans, players, sponsors, and communities alike—so too must its supporting systems. The existing manual ticketing approach is no longer sustainable in terms of revenue protection, scalability, fan convenience, or brand strength.

This proposal introduces a modern, secure, and interactive digital platform designed not only to digitize ticketing but to redefine how fans engage with their teams and how BPL operates as a digital-first league.

11.2 Strategic Recommendation

We strongly recommend the adoption and implementation of the **BPL Digital Ticketing & Media Ecosystem**, which comprises:

- A **fan-facing mobile app** that empowers users to buy, manage, and transfer tickets, read team-specific content, and receive personalized notifications.
- A lightweight **steward app** to simplify ticket validation and attendance tracking on match days—even in low-connectivity environments.
- A powerful **CRM and management console** offering a 360° view of fan behavior, steward performance, and content performance, with dashboards that turn data into action.

This system is:

- **Cost-efficient**, saving BPL thousands of dollars annually in printing and distribution
- **Revenue-protective**, reducing leakages and fraud
- **Fan-centric**, providing personalized experiences and improving loyalty
- **Sustainable**, with scalable architecture and modular future enhancements
- **Commercially attractive**, opening new revenue streams from advertising and partnerships

11.3 The Call to Action

BPL has an opportunity to become a trailblazer among African football leagues by adopting a system that matches the passion of its fans with technology that reflects the future. With a go-live

timeline set for early September 2025 and a carefully phased roadmap in place, this is the right time to act.

We invite the BPL executive team and stakeholders to:

- **Approve the proposal for Phase 1 development**
- **Allocate budget and nominate stakeholder champions**
- **Engage clubs and sponsors early for pilot readiness**

11.4 Final Thought

Football is more than 90 minutes. It's identity, community, culture, and memory. This proposal isn't just about ticketing—it's about building the **digital stadium** of tomorrow, where every fan belongs and every ticket counts.